



Grade 2 Social Studies

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 2 · FULL YEAR

160 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in sources, activities, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

In Grade 2 Social Studies, scholars explore the people, places, and ideas that shape communities past and present, using historical and geographic perspectives to understand how individuals and groups interact, contribute, and govern. Through stories, pictures, maps, and careful observation, scholars investigate American history and citizenship, map their world, and consider the cultural influences and economic choices that connect them to their local community and the wider world. As Florida's course frames it, second graders investigate the impact of immigration over time in the United States, explore the geography of North America, and discover the foundations of American citizenship. The seven Optima virtues connect to the people and habits scholars study throughout the year.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 American History (strand)

Historical inquiry and analysis, historical knowledge, and chronological thinking: primary and secondary sources, Native American peoples, the changing life of Colonial America, and the reasons people have come to the United States over time, including Ellis Island and the Statue of Liberty.

2 Geography (strand)

The world in spatial terms: using political, physical, and thematic maps; locating the hometown, Florida, and North America; and labeling continents, oceans, the Equator, the Prime Meridian, and the poles.

3 Economics (strand)

Beginning economics: making choices with limited resources, supply and consumer demand, trade between nations, and the benefits and costs of saving and spending.

4 Civics (strand)

Foundations of government, civic and political participation, and the structure and functions of government: why people form governments, how the Constitution protects citizens' rights, what it means to be a citizen, and the symbols, individuals, and documents that represent the nation and state.

5 African American History (strand)

Positive influences and contributions by African Americans, including figures of civic service and the oral traditions and folktales that are part of the nation's story.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two social studies lessons each week.
- The first builds background through stories, pictures, maps, and guided observation.
- The second is applied work such as map activities, sequencing events, role-play, or notebook narration.
- The seven Optima virtues connect to the people and habits scholars study throughout the year.

TIME COMMITMENT

160 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 80 minutes each

- Each week pairs one background lesson with one applied lesson.
- Project and exhibition weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A notebook for drawings, narrations, and simple maps.
- Crayons or colored pencils and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- An adult to support young learners (especially in Kindergarten).

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week on the school's weekly schedule.